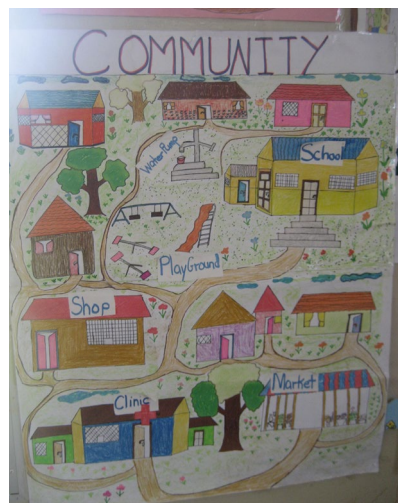


Liberia National ECD Curriculum: Teacher Planner

3- to 6-Year-Olds

MY NEIGHBORHOOD: January and February



Ministry of Education / Bureau of Early Childhood Education

2017

INTRODUCTION TO MY NEIGHBORHOOD

The content area “**My Neighborhood**” is planned for two months approximately – **January and February** and includes the following topics, each of them might last one – two weeks depending on the interest of children:

My Neighborhood

I.			Road Transportation		2 weeks		1
II.			Water and Air Transportation		2 weeks		17
III.			Markets, Playgrounds		2 weeks		44
IV.			Community Helpers		2 weeks		53



I: ROAD TRANSPORTATION

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

The topic about road transportation focuses on how people, animals and things are transported by road, especially on farms. Children learn best when dealing with the familiar things, so activities should be related to the children's experience involving forms of transportation that they see in their environment. Older children can benefit from other sub-topics, which focus on water (ships and boats) and air transportation, which might not be so familiar to all children.

The first form of transportation for people was either to be carried by other people or by animals, especially on horseback. Other animals have been also used to transport people and things, such as oxen and donkeys.

The invention of wheels was very important for the development of transportation; roads were made to make it easier for animals to pull carts, wagons and coaches from place to place. Finally people invented machines (vehicles) that could run on paths and roads, such as bicycles, cars, taxis, buses, trucks, motorcycles, tractors and trailers.

There are many different types of transportation to talk to children about. Vehicles come in different shapes, sizes and colors; they have different uses, and are made of a variety of materials such as wood, metal, rubber, steel, glass. Therefore this topic is useful for strengthening children's understanding of many different concepts and for classification activities.

While talking about transportation teachers can introduce such concepts as **direction** and **positions** (e.g., roads go past our houses, around bends, across main roads, they go under or over the bridges, and roads are either straight or curved). Concepts of speed and distance can be introduced also (e.g. Is it possible to walk to the nearest village? Why not? How long would it take if we walked? Or travelled by bus or by taxi? Why?)

This topic also provides a good opportunity to help children learn about road safety and rules of the road, road signs, pedestrian (i.e. people walking on the street) crossings, and using safety belts in cars. The role of the traffic officer can also be discussed as well as other work roles in the transport business.



WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – January, Week 1 and 2

I: Road Transportation

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	• Welcome children • Greetings • What is the topic for the week? • Exploring the Vehicles	• Welcome children • Greetings • What is the topic for the week? • Exploring the Vehicles	• Welcome children • Greetings • Different Types of Transportation	• Welcome children • Greetings • Different Types of Transportation	• Welcome children • Greetings • What is the topic for the week? • Road Safety
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups Week 1	Cars and Garages	Cars and Garages	Group Collage	Group Collage	Road Safety
	Small Groups Week 2	Bridges and Tunnels	Cars and Garages			
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Exploring Roads	Bus or Taxi	Wheelbarrow Races	Group Collage	Road Safety
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.45 – 14.15	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic.				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				

Activities with Parents throughout the day	• Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities • Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling • Parents can learn an activity and practice at home



A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



Exploring Vehicles

Objectives:

- To explore what a car, bicycle, etc. looks and feels like (for younger children) and to compare two or more vehicles (for older children).
- To introduce the names of different parts of the vehicle, the materials they are made from, and their functions
- Invite a truck driver or mechanic to the class.

Materials needed: None

Preparation:

1. Locate a vehicle to be brought to the Center or a vehicle that the children can be brought to.

Instructions:

Beginner

1. Try to arrange for a familiar vehicle to be brought to the Center.
2. Explore one vehicle – let the children explore (look and touch) the different parts of the vehicle(s) from the outside, e.g. tires, the tread on tires, bumpers, windscreen, wipers, bonnet, and older children can compare the different vehicles (color, size, shape, type of wheels, and so on).
3. Then encourage children to look inside the vehicle(s). Talk about the seats, brakes, gear lever, steering wheel, speedometer, where to switch the car on and off, and what everything is used for. Open the hood to look at the engine, the battery and perhaps the radiator (for the water to keep the engine cool). Open the trunk, discuss what can be placed inside, show the children all the parts of the car or truck.
4. Talk about the different kinds of materials that the different parts are made from, e.g. tires from rubber, windscreen from glass; the windscreen wipers have rubber blades, etc.
5. After you have discussed all parts of the car, ask the children questions about what they see, for example: You can draw a picture of a car to help with the next part.
 - *Name a part of the car and ask the children:*
“Where is the steering wheel? Where is the windshield? Where is the door?”

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Counting Questions:

- *Do you see any circles on the car? How many circles are there? Where is/are the circle? (Tyres, Steering wheel, speedometer, etc.) Rectangles?*
- *How many doors are there? Etc...*
- *What do you sit on in the vehicle? Where would you like to sit?*

Texture questions

- *What is a smooth surface?*
- *What is bumpy?*
- *What is soft? Etc...*

Color questions

- *What colors do you see?*
- *What is the darkest color?*
- *What is the lightest color?*

Size Questions

- *What is the biggest vehicle?*
 - *What is the smallest vehicle?*
 - *Which vehicle has the largest wheels?*
 - *Which vehicle has the smallest wheels?*
6. After looking at the real cars, trucks, and taxi's, motorcycles, return to the classroom so children can compare what they have seen with similar toy models (if available) or pictures.
 7. If it is not possible to explore a real car or truck, or more than one real car or truck, then toy models or pictures can be used in the discussion described above.

Intermediate/Advanced

1. Try to arrange for the children to look at several cars and trucks (2-3) either by taking them somewhere where they can look at several different kinds of vehicles or having the vehicle brought to the center.
2. Let them explore (look at and touch) the different parts of the car or truck(s) from the outside, e.g. tires, the tread on tires, bumpers, windscreen, wipers, bonnet, and older children can compare the different vehicles (color, size, shape, type of wheels, and so on).
3. Then encourage children to look inside car(s) or truck(s). Talk about the seats, brakes, gear lever, steering wheel, speedometer, where to switch the car on and off, etc. Open the bonnet to look at the engine, the battery and perhaps the radiator (for the water to keep the engine cool). Ask questions to get the children talking for example:

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- Why do you think the windscreen is made from glass?*
 - What else could be used to make the windscreen?*
 - What would happen if the steering wheel of the car (truck or tractor) was at the back of the car?*
 - What shape are cars/trucks usually?*
 - Do you think we could drive in a round or triangular car/truck?*
 - What are the names of some kinds of cars?*
 - Why do you think a bicycle does not fall over when it is being ridden?*
 - How do you think we could stop a vehicle if it did not have brakes?*
 - Why do you think the tires of cars and bicycles are round?*
 - What would happen if they were square in shape?*
 - Try and remember the names of all the different things we have seen on the car or bicycle today.*
 - Open the trunk– ask the children “what is it used for?”*
4. Talk about the different kinds of materials that the different parts are made from, e.g. tires from rubber, windscreen from glass; the windscreen wipers have rubber blades, and so on.
 5. After looking at the real car(s) and truck(s) return to the playroom and children could compare what they have seen with similar toy models (if available) or pictures.
 6. If it is not possible to explore a real car or truck, or more that one real vehicle then toy models or pictures can be used in the discussion described above.



Different Types of Transportation

Objectives:

- To compare different kinds of transport and machines with wheels, and discuss their functions.

Materials needed:

- Posters on road transportation
- Magazine pictures of different kinds of vehicles
- Hand drawn pictures of cars, trucks, motorcycles, wagons etc. (if needed)

Instructions:

Beginner:

1. Display the pictures of the different kinds of vehicles on a wall (or flannel board if you have one).
2. Point to the different pictures and ask children if they know the names for them. Ask the children if they know what the different vehicles are used for. Discuss the different functions of transport, e.g. to transport people, animals and goods (e.g. farm produce, building materials, food, furniture). Talk about vehicles that have specific uses, e.g. petrol tankers, tractors, seed planters.

Intermediate/Advanced

1. Display the pictures of the different kinds of vehicles on against a wall (or flannel board if you have one). Try to have a variety of different types of trucks (e.g.pick-up trucks, flatbed trucks and large dump trucks), and farm vehicles (e.g. ploughs, etc.) and big road machines, such as graders, bulldozers, or steamrollers).
3. Point to the different pictures and ask children to name them. Ask the children if they know what the different vehicles are used for. Discuss the different functions of transport, e.g. to transport people, animals and goods (e.g. farm produce, building materials, food, furniture). Talk about vehicles that have specific uses, e.g. gasoline tankers, dump trucks, etc..
4. Use the following questions to generate discussion of the vehicles
 - *What is the same on all the vehicles? What is different?*

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- Why do vehicles that are used to transport people look different to those that transport furniture (goods)?*
- Name some of the things that we could load into a truck, car, trailer, bicycle, etc.*
- Which is the biggest vehicle for taking many people?*
- What is it called? How many people can go in a bus?*
- Which is the smallest (taking one person)? What is it called?*
- What are some of the places that local people travel to and from?*
- What gets transported in tankers?*
- What are the different things you can see on a bulldozer?*
- What noises do the engines make when far away? When near?*
- Why is the delivery bike man wearing a helmet on his head?*
- Why does the taxi have luggage on the roof?*
- Any additional questions that you can think of!*



Road Safety

Objective: To help children understand more about the rules of the road and road safety.

Materials needed:

- Road signs
- “Road” – something to stand for the road (could be a piece of cardboard painted to look like a road)
- Toy or improvised cars

Instructions:

Beginner:

1. Show the children road signs and talk about what they mean.
2. Talk about crossing street/road safety (holding hands of an adult), group walking safety – using a buddy system walking along road safety, car safety (wearing a seatbelt when inside the car, use if available), bike safety, where it is safe to play versus not safe to play.
3. Practice walking game. Stand with a sign with one side green and one side red at the “road”. Have the children walk up to the road, and then show them either the red or the green sign. Ask the children The sign is red/green can you walk?

Intermediate/Advanced:

1. If inside, show children how cars and people would use the roads, look at road signs and obey them. If outside, help the children to act out the road rules.
2. Talk about what side of the road to walk on, where and how to cross the roads, where to play and where not to play. Also, talk about the importance of wearing safety belts in cars and helmets on bikes.
3. Talk to the children about a traffic officer, what his/her role is and what he/she wears. If possible have some pictures of a traffic officer showing his/her uniform and car.

B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Group Collage

Objectives:

- To encourage group work, cooperation and sharing.
- To develop planning skills and awareness of spatial relationships.

Materials needed:

- 8-10 double pages of newspaper or sheets of newsprint
- Poster paint or thick mud paint and brushes (see paint section pg. xx)
- Cement
- Paper
- Leaves
- Wood chaff (sawdust)
- Pieces of sticks
- Ashes
- Sand

Instructions:

Beginner:

1. Stick the pieces of newspaper or newsprint next to each other on an empty space on the walls of the playroom at the children's eye level. Place more newspaper on the floor with containers of paint (in box holders) and brushes along the wall.
2. Draw a simple outline of a road with a few bends in it running from one end of the paper to the other. Draw or stick a few buildings along the road, a car or two, and perhaps a bridge.
3. Tell children you need their help to finish the mural. Give them some cut outs of vehicles, signs, trees, buildings, etc. on separate pieces of paper, have the children decorate the cut outs, or draw details directly onto the mural. Encourage the children to use a variety of different media which could include drawing with crayons, painting, cutting out pictures from magazines, and models of cars and houses constructed from cardboard boxes and other scrap materials. Help them stick their cutouts onto the mural.
4. *** Include a discussion of the mural during group time and have children to talk about their paintings and or the whole mural – ask them questions about what is going on in the mural. ***

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Intermediate/Advanced:

1. Stick the pieces of newspaper or newsprint next to each other on an empty space on the walls of the playroom at the children's eye level. Place more newspaper on the floor with containers of paint (in box holders) and brushes along the wall.
2. Draw a simple outline of a road with a few bends in it running from one end of the paper to the other. Draw or stick a few buildings along the road, a car or two, and perhaps a bridge.
3. Tell children you need their help to finish the mural. Tell them they can draw and/or paint vehicles, signs, trees, buildings, etc. on separate pieces of paper, cut them out and stick them onto the mural. Encourage the children to use a variety of different media which could include drawing with crayons, painting, cutting out pictures from magazines, and models of cars and houses constructed from cardboard boxes and other scrap materials.
4. Help them to plan their paintings around the roads and buildings by asking questions, such as:
 - *What other kinds of vehicles could go in the picture?*
 - *Who would like to draw the tractor and trailer?*
 - *Where are you going to draw it?*
 - *What road signs do you need on this road?*
 - *What else could you draw to make a nice picture?*
5. *** Include a discussion of the mural during group time and have children to talk about their paintings and or the whole mural – ask them questions about what is going on in the mural. ***



Cars and Garages

Objectives:

- To develop skills in recognizing numerals and matching these with the same number of dots.
- To extend children's play in the Block Center.

Materials needed:

- 10 empty juice cartons or boxes of about the same size
- 10 small plastic or improvised cars (e.g. small blocks could be used)
- Small pieces of paper
- Glue or paste or sticky tape
- Marker

Preparation:

1. Cut the tops of the milk cartons off, or make sure that the box is open on one side to make 'garages'. Write the numbers from 1-10 on the small pieces of paper. Turn the boxes on their sides and stick one number onto the top side of each box.
2. Mark each of the 'cars' with dots from 1-10 respectively, so that you will have one car with 1 dot on, a second car with 2 dots on, a third with 3 dots on, and so on. (You may prefer to put the dots on paper and stick the paper on each car.)

Instructions:

1. This activity can be set out with the building blocks, either inside or outside on a hard, flat surface.
2. Start the game by asking children to count the dots on each car, e.g.
 - *How many dots are on this car?*
 - *Can you find a garage that this car can drive into?*
 - *Why do you think this car can go into this particular garage?*
 - *If I drive this car (with 4 dots) into this garage (with 1 on it) would it be okay?*
3. Children can then be left to play the game on their own. Encourage them to use blocks, pieces of cardboard and other materials in the playroom to make a gas pump, roads and bridges for the cars to travel on.



Road Safety

Objectives:

- To encourage children to think about the rules of the road and recognize basic road signs.
- To encourage creative and fun play.

Materials needed:

- Large cardboard box flattened out or large piece of sacking or old sheet or newspaper pages stuck together
- Road sign drawings
- A selection of blocks plastic or improvised cars and trucks
- Cardboard boxes of different sizes
- Pieces of cardboard
- A Box cut into strips about 10 cm/inches wide and 30 cm/inches long
- Old piece of thin plastic piping or straws black paint or thick mud paint,
- Crayons
- Sticks

Preparation:

1. Use the black paint to draw (with a pencil and ruler first) some simple roads (two black lines about 15 -20 cm/ inches apart with road markings in the middle), with pedestrian crossings and intersections onto the large piece of cardboard (sacking, old sheet or newspaper). Put this into the block corner or in a suitable flat place outside.
2. Color in the drawings of basic road signs and paste them on cardboard. Cut them out and fix them onto small sticks, which can be stuck into clay or play dough bases.
3. Set out a variety of boxes and pieces of cardboard that the children can use as buildings and to make ramps, bridges, tunnels, gas pumps (make a hole on the side of suitable small box and stick the piece of old piping or straw in it).
4. Impvise cars, trucks and bicycles using blocks or provide small plastic models.

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Instructions:

1. 1. Encourage children to play using all the different materials you have added. You may need to lay out the first 'scene' with road signs and some of the boxes or blocks along the side of the road as buildings or garages, and show the children how to make bridges and ramps, tunnels, etc.
2. 2. Talk to the children about the different roads and what they mean. Ask the children why you have put the signs in a particular place, what the car drivers must or must not do.
3. 3. When the 'scene' is set out, encourage the children to play make-believe games with the cars, trucks, etc.
4. 4. The following day let the children set out the materials in their own way.
5. 5. This activity can be set up outside in a sandy area where the children can make roads by pushing blocks through the sand.
6. 6. Use existing paths in the playground as roads and perhaps draw additional roads in the ground. Provide larger boxes for buildings, and make the road signs bigger. The children can 'drive' the large toys with tyres, such as wheelrings, sidewalk taxis, tree wheel taxi (if available), large wire cars or old tires round these roads and obey the traffic signs.



Bridges and Tunnels

Objectives:

- To develop cooperative skills through joint play.
- To learn to count, concentrate and follow the rules.

Materials needed:

- A piece of cardboard 30 cm/inches by 30 cm /inches (from a large box)
- Drawing of game board
- Crayons or paints, scissors and glue
- Plastic contact or varnish (if available)
- 4 very small 'cars' (either plastic or improvised)
- Dice (or dots 1-6 on small pieces of same sized card that children can draw out of a bag) storage box

Preparation:

1. Color in the drawing of the game board. Make all the bridges one color and all the tunnels another color.
2. Stick the drawing onto the large piece of cardboard. Make sure that all the ends are stuck down, and if possible cover the board with clear plastic contact or paint with clear varnish to strengthen and protect it.
3. A dice can be made by using a small square block of wood (about 2 cm/inches x 2 cm x 2 cm) and drawing the dots onto it.

Instructions:

1. Roll dice and move around the board the number of places on the dice.
2. Follow the road, doing whatever the board says to do.
3. Whoever gets to the "house" or "village" first gets to do something else of their choosing while the others finish.

C. IDEAS FOR OUTDOOR GAMES



Exploring Roads

Objectives: To discuss differences of the road: what they look like; how they are made; and, who uses them.

Materials needed: None

Instructions:

Beginner:

1. Plan a group walk around your neighborhood. Before you leave the playroom tell the children where you are going to walk. Explain what the children should look out for. Remind them about the rules of the walk, e.g. they must not run into the road, children must hold hands with their partner, they must keep away from where people and machines are working.
2. Talk about what side of the road to walk on, where and how to cross the roads, where to play and where not to play. Also talk about the importance of wearing safety belts in cars and helmets on bikes.
3. Take the children on a walk around the nearby roads. If any road-making or road repair work is being done in the neighborhood, try to arrange to take the group to watch the workers and the machines at work.
4. During the walk, ask the children questions to draw their attention to different things you want them to look at. Encourage them to feel the surface of the roads. Ask questions about sounds that you may hear. Children can look for tire tracks in the sand and for road signs.
5. Talk to the children about the traffic officer, what his role is and what he wears. If possible have some pictures of a traffic officer showing his uniform, white gloves for directing traffic, and his car. If outside, perhaps the make-believe game.
6. When you return to the playroom spend 5-10 minutes encouraging the children to talk about what they saw on the walk. Talk about roads that go over bridges, under bridges, round bends, cross other roads, that lead to town. Talk about the differences between gravel roads and tar roads and about the workers on the roads and the special clothing they wear for safety.

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Intermediate/ Advanced

1. Plan a group walk around your neighborhood. Before you leave the playroom tell the children where you are going to walk. Explain what the children should look out for. Remind them about the rules of the walk, e.g. they must not run into the road, children must hold hands with their partner, they must keep away from where people and machines are working.
2. Talk about what side of the road to walk on, where and how to cross the roads, where to play and where not to play. Also talk about the importance of wearing safety belts in cars and helmets on bikes.
3. Take the children on a walk around the nearby roads. If any road-making or road repair work is being done in the neighborhood, try to arrange to take the group to watch the workers and the machines at work.
4. During the walk, ask the children questions to draw their attention to different things you want them to look at. Encourage them to feel the surface of the roads. Ask questions about sounds that you may hear. Children can look for tire tracks in the sand and for road signs.
5. Talk to the children about the traffic officer, what his role is and what he wears. If possible have some pictures of a traffic officer showing his uniform, white gloves for directing traffic, and his car. If outside, perhaps the make-believe game.
6. When you return to the playroom spend 5-10 minutes encouraging the children to talk about what they saw on the walk. Talk about roads that go over bridges, under bridges, round bends, cross other roads, that lead to town. Talk about the differences between gravel roads and tar roads and about the workers on the roads and the special clothing they wear for safety.
7. Extending the discussion to the way roads are made or repaired and the machines that are used, like the grader, tip trucks, steamroller.



Bus or Taxi

Objectives:

- To extend children's play by introducing different roles and responsibilities.
- To encourage children to work together as a group, share, take turns.

Materials needed:

- Old jackets and caps
- 'Bus tickets' (pieces of paper) and play money
- Something that could be used as a steering wheel
- Chairs, boxes, cushions/pillows or mats

Instructions:

1. Set out this activity inside or outside.
 2. Create a bus, minibus or taxi depending on what is most familiar to the children, with the help of the children. Set out chairs, boxes, cushions or mats in rows like the seats in a bus or taxi. Remember to have one chair for the driver with the 'steering wheel' in front of it.
 3. Have a jacket (e.g. old adult shirt) and cap for the bus driver and box or bag for the 'tickets' and 'money'. Make a sign for the bus stop or a large box for the shelter where people can wait for the bus.
 4. Encourage children to stand in line to catch the bus at the bus stop. Give them each some play money. As they board the bus, they buy a ticket from the driver. The driver can give 'change'. They set off and the bus 'stops' from time to time for people to get on and off. Have the role of the bus driver be played by the children. He can be quiet, talkative, a bit angry. Have the children identify how he seems to be feeling. Ask them how they feel if the bus driver seems angry.
 5. Depending on what happens in the areas where children live, activities in and around the bus stops can also be set up, e.g. selling vegetables, newspapers, clothes, etc.
 6. Make sure that children take turns at being the driver. Encourage them to talk about where the bus is going, the bus fare one way and return, how often the bus goes to town, does it work on weekends, etc.
- **Another idea for encouraging make-believe play is to set out a garage using the things made with scrap materials. Add your own ideas too.****



II: WATER AND AIR TRANSPORTATION

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

This topic builds on the previous topic “Road Transportation” and it is planned around water and air transportation, which extends learning opportunities for children by introducing to them less familiar forms of transportation: ships, boats and rafts (water transportation) and airplanes (air transportation).

It is important to relate these topics to past learning about transportation, going from the familiar to the unfamiliar, e.g. compare a bus to a ship – passengers buy tickets on both; but at the same time pointing at the differences – bus and taxi have wheels and move by roads while ship doesn’t have wheels and moves by water, etc.

Some information that may be useful for teachers:

Floating – a boat or ship floats because of the way it is built. Much of the boat is filled by air, which is much lighter than water. If a boat is constructed correctly, it will weigh less than the water that would take up the same space even when the boat is loaded with cargo, crew and passengers.

Submarines are ships that are specially designed to travel under the water. They have tanks that are filled with seawater to make them heavy enough to sink. When the submarine is ready to come up, the water in the tanks is replaced by compressed air which makes it light enough to float.

Dry dock is found on large harbors for repairing and painting big ships to prevent them getting rusty, especially the part (hull) that stays in the water all the time. The dry dock is like a huge garage with no roof. The ship is pushed into the dock by a tugboat. Then the entrance is closed, and as water is pumped out the dock, the ship is propped up with pieces of wood. When the repairs and painting are finished, the water is let in again, the ship floats and the tug pulls it back into the harbor.

Lighthouses are built on land that sticks out into the sea to warn ships where the land is at night. A lighthouse is a tall tower with a huge light at the top. It flashes on and off at night. It may also have a foghorn to make a loud noise in places where there can be thick fog (mist) in the daytime.

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Flight – airplanes fly because of the work done by the propellers or jets, the wings and the engine. The engines provide power to turn the propellers or provide a forward thrust (jets) for the airplanes. This causes air to flow over the wings. The wings are curved on top and flat on the bottom. As an airplane moves forward faster and faster, the air flowing over the curved part of the wings does not push down as much as the slower air pushes up under the wings. So the airplane lifts off the ground and flies through the air.

Helicopters have rotor blades which are a combination of a propeller and wings. The rotors pull the machine straight up into the air.

Gliders float on moving air, but they have to be pulled up into the air by an airplane (paper airplanes are like gliders).



WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – January, Week 3 and 4

II: Water and Air Transportation

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Review of the Transportation	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Transportation Guessing Game	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Balloons and Power	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Sound Match	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Review the Transportation
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups Week 3	Wet Paper Painting	Water Transportation Number Game	Making Propellers	Floating and Sinking	Paper Bag Kites
	Small Groups Week 4	Water Transportation Number Game	Wet Paper Painting	Floating and Sinking	Making Propellers	
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Wet Paper Painting	Wet Paper Painting	Making Propellers	Making Propellers	Paper Bag Kites
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.00 – 12.45	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic.				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				
Activities with Parents throughout the day		• Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities • Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling • Parents can accompany class on trash walk				



A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



Different Types of Transportation

Objectives:

- To make children feel welcome on a Monday morning.
- To introduce the topic for the week.
- To prepare children for activities that will happen later in the day or during the week, such as a planned outing and other special group activities.
- To extend children understands of classification and number concepts.

Materials needed:

- Drawings (or other pictures) of different kinds of road, water and air transport (at least one for each child)
- Category drawings
- Cardboard (e.g. cereal boxes) or paper, scissors, paste

Preparation:

1. Make enough *transport cards* so that each child can be given one or two (depending on the size of the group). Select a variety of transport drawings, including all **three** kinds (road, water, air). Color in, cut out and paste them onto pieces of cardboard or paper. The children can use the same card(s) each week.
2. Make the *category cards* suggested for each week on the next page by cutting out the drawings provided. Paste these onto separate pieces of cardboard or paper.

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Categories:

The following categories are suggested:

1. **Type of transport:** road, water, and air.
– *Where can you drive or use your transport?*
2. **Number of wheels:** two, four, many, none (blank).
– *How many wheels does it have?*
3. **Uses of the transport:** mainly for carrying people, goods and animals, other (blank, e.g. for war, pulling things, fun).
– *What is it used for most of the time?*
4. **Power:** engine (petrol pump - needs fuel), people, animals, other (e.g. wind) *What makes it go/move?*

Instructions:

1. Welcome the children back after the weekend. Each week put up the relevant category cards (road week, air week, water week). Make sure that the children understand what the picture cards show (represent), and link the classification task with what they have learned previously. Also check that they know what their transport is.
2. Help children to decide which picture to put their transport card next to, especially if they have to choose between more than one picture (e.g. rowing boats can transport people or goods; not all wheels are shown).
3. Talk about how many kinds of transport are classified in each group. Ask questions and talk about (compare) the different kinds of transport in relation to the category, e.g. number of wheels.
 - *How many wheels do most/least of the transport have?*
 - *What other transport has four wheels?*
 - *What kind of transport has no wheels?*
 - *Do all airplanes have wheels to land on?*
 - *Which kinds of transport carry many people?*
 - *In what ways are big ships and trains the same?*
 - *What kind of fuel does a steam engine use? (coal)*
 - *How do people make bicycles / rowing boats / canoes move? What parts of their bodies are used?*



Boats and Ships

Objective: Children learn more about why boats float, and to talk about boats and ships as a means of transportation.

Materials needed:

- A plastic container with water
- Cup of sand
- Models or a real boat (e.g. a canoe) to look at
- 2 pieces of aluminum foil of the same size,
- Posters and pictures of different kinds of boats

Instructions:

1. Show the children posters and pictures of boats and ships, especially if they are not familiar with them. A real boat or realistic models (e.g. toy boat or clay model) would be even better. Talk about what boats are used for.
2. Children may wonder how something as big and as heavy as a boat can float. Show them the two pieces of foil (which are exactly the same size) and ask them whether they think they will float or sink.
 - *What are boats used for? Are boats heavy or light?*
 - *Can boats carry heavy things, like people, cars?*
 - *Why do boats float in water if they are heavy or full of heavy things?*
 - *Do you think the foil will float or sink? Why?*
 - *Why do you think the foil sank to the bottom?*
 - *How can we make this piece float?*
 - *Why do you think it floats?*
 - *What would happen if we put sand into the boat? Why?*
 - *What could make a boat sink? What could happen to the people in the boat?*
3. Ask a child to take one of the pieces and make it into a tight ball. Will the ball sink or float? The child puts it into the water. It will sink.
4. Ask another child to make a boat from the other piece of foil by turning up the edges (or make it yourself). Put it in the water and it will float (make sure that it does not leak).
5. Talk about the shape of the boat and the shape of the ball. Explain that real boats float because of their shape. They hold a lot of air which is lighter than water.
6. Ask a child to slowly put sand in the boat and see what happens. Ask questions that will help children to think for themselves, rather than tell them that light things float and heavy things sink.
7. Talk about what could make a boat sink (a leak, overloaded, turns over) and the need for people to wear life jackets in small boats.



The Harbor or Port

Objective: To increase children's knowledge of the wider world in which they live. A harbor part of the ocean or river that is next to land and that is protected and deep enough to keep ships and boats safe. A port is a harbor town or city where ships may take on or deliver cargo (i.e. passengers, boxes, cars, containers of furniture etc.). Some harbors in Liberia are the Freeport Harbor of Monrovia, the Port of Buchanan and the Port of Maryland County.

Materials needed:

- Posters and pictures of different kinds of boats and ships and the harbor and port.

Instructions:

1. If children have had an experience of water transportation, encourage them to talk about what they saw and did and felt about it.
2. Talk about the different kinds of small boats and what makes them move - people rowing with oars (or paddles for canoes), wind blowing against sails, engines on motor boats and fishing boats.
3. Use the harbor poster to talk about the big ships that go on the sea. Compare the harbor to a bus station. Big ships carry goods, which are loaded onto them with cranes. Big passenger ships are like floating hotels (huge houses with many small bedrooms called cabins). Cabins also have bunks like train compartments. People have to go up a gang plank (a wooden board connecting the boat to the land) to get onto a ship.
4. Show the children pictures of different kinds of big ships (if available). Tugboats have to push big ships in and out of the harbor. They will also be interested in the submarine that travels under the water (used in war).
5. Talk about the work that people do on ships and at the harbor. The captain of the ship has many people (crew) helping him to run the ship. Note that people who work on ships (including the fishing trawlers) are often away from home for long periods.



Airplanes

Objective:

- To help children learn more about airplanes and how they fly, and to have fun.
- Increase fine motor skills

Materials needed:

- Paper (8" x 11")
- Paper propeller
- Posters and pictures of airplanes and the airport

Preparation:

Make paper glider airplanes in the following way:

1. Fold the paper in half lengthwise, and open it again.
2. Fold the top two corners in toward the center fold line.
3. Fold the two top sections again in the same way toward the centre fold line.
4. Fold the paper in half along the first fold.
5. Fold each half back from the point toward the centre fold again so that the edges are even with each other along the long sides.
6. Hold it together underneath and lift up the "wings". You can use a paper clip (or paste) to hold the 'body' of the airplane together.

******Make enough paper airplanes so that not more than three children will have to share one. For advanced/older children, teachers can also show children how to make their own airplanes.

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Instructions:

1. 1. Hold up one of the paper airplanes in front of you and ask children what it is and if anyone knows how it moves. Discuss the shape of the airplane and the different parts -the wings, the front and the back.
2. Let children take turns in trying to fly the planes. (You may need to settle them afterwards with a song or finger play as this is very active and fun.)
3. Encourage the children to talk about their experiences. Ask what they think made the airplane move through the air.
 - *How did you make the airplane fly?*
 - *What made it stay up? Does it fly like a bird?*
 - *What would happen if the airplane had no wings?*
 - *How do you think a big, heavy airplane stays up in the sky?*
 - *Which do you think is faster - an airplane or a motorbike? Why?*
 - *What do you think the wheels are used for? , Can people fly? Why not?*
 - *Would you rather ride in an airplane or in a train? Why?*
 - *What would happen if the airplane stopped working while it was in the sky?*
4. Talk about the different kinds of airplanes - this is a glider plane and it uses air currents to move through the air. Show pictures of other kinds of airplanes. Discuss airplanes with engines and propellers.
5. Tell the children about the different uses of airplanes and the people that work on the airplane and at the airport.



Review of Transportation

Objective: To review road, water and air transport, and compare similarities and differences.

Materials needed:

- Sticks, small stones, twigs, leaves
- Piece of blue material or paper
- Paint and brushes, small cardboard boxes
- Clay, papier-mâché and/or plastic models
- Piece of green material or paper
- All the transportation posters and pictures

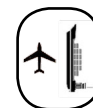
Preparation:

1. Make simple clay or papier-mâché models of boats, airplanes, a train and vehicles. Once they are dry, paint them. (You can also use plastic or wooden models if these are available, or improvise with boxes, or use cut-outs pasted onto strong card.)
2. Fill the large shallow box with sand and make a countryside scene from the other materials
3. You can make a railway track by arranging small twigs in the sand like the railway line sleepers, water by cutting out a shape out of the blue material or paper, and an airfield by cutting out green paper or material to put around the runway. Roads can be made in the sand with small stones or blocks.
4. Complete the scene by sticking leaves in the sand for trees. Painted boxes can be buildings such as a railway station, airport or houses. Use your imagination to create bridges, signposts or tunnels.

Instructions:

1. Show children the pictures or poster of transportation vehicles.
2. Ask the children what they see in the pictures or posters. Talk about the roads and what vehicles would travel on them. Discuss what the reason for the journey might be - is the truck carrying goods to the station? Perhaps a bus is taking children to school?
3. Each child can be given a model to talk about how it is made and what it might be used for. Then ask the child to show where and how it moves.

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4. Encourage the children to compare and classify all the different kinds of transportation. Use models and pictures.
5. Ask questions about transportation methods to get children to talk.
 - How will the truck get to the farm?
 - Which ones do not have wheels? How are the wheels used by the others? How are the wheels different?
 - Which have engines to make them go? What do the others use? (wind, people - bicycle, rowing boat)
 - Which is faster - the car or the airplane? Why?
 - Where do you think the ship is going? Why?
 - Which is bigger, the airplane or the ship?
 - Which transport people and which animals and goods?
 - Which form of transport can carry the most people? (ship, bus) the least? (bicycle, horse, canoe)
 - How are a bus and airplane the same?
 - Would you rather travel on an airplane or a ship? Why?
 - Who drives the bus /airplane /ship?
 - Which kinds of transport are owned by families? And which do you have to pay to use?



Transport Guessing Game

Objective: To learn to listen and make verbal part-whole connections.

Instructions:

1. Tell the children to listen very carefully to what you say and then try to guess what you are talking about, e.g.
 - I am very large. I can float on top of water. I can also travel under the water. What am I? (a submarine)
2. You could play similar guessing games around the people that work with different types of transport, e.g.
 - I wear a smart uniform and cap. I ride on bus and check people's tickets. Who am I? (bus conductor)
3. Do not use more than 3 ideas at a time.
4. Encourage children to think up their own clues and let others guess what they are.



Balloons and Power

Objective: To introduce the idea that air can move things.

Materials needed:

- Balloon for each child
- Inside tube of a toilet roll for each child
- Paper propeller, pictures and posters of airplanes

Instructions:

1. Show children the balloons and ask them if they know what they are and what they can do. Explain and show children how to blow up the balloons. Warn them that the balloon could pop if it is blown up too hard and that it will make a loud noise. Give each child a balloon to blow up and help where necessary.
2. When the balloons are blown up, ask children to let them go and see what happens. Give children time to experiment. Ask the children to describe what happens and explain why.
3. When they are used to blowing up the balloons, give each child a toilet roll tube. Then they release the balloon into the tube, and see what happens.
4. Once again you will need to gather and settle them with a song. Discuss what happened and let individuals share their experiences. Talk about how the escaping air pushes the balloon forward.
 - *What happened to the balloon when you let it go?*
 - *How did the balloon move?*
 - *Why do you think this happened?*
 - *What happens if you let the air out very slowly?*
5. Continue talking about airplanes; how the propellers and engines make the air move fast to push the airplane forward; taking off and landing, and so on.



Sound Match

Objective: To develop listening skills.

Materials needed: Transportation cards

Instructions:

Beginners:

1. Discuss the sounds various forms of transportation make. As a group have the children answer what sound or sounds do the following forms of transportation make:
 - Train
 - Car
 - Bus
 - Motorcycle
 - Truck
 - Boat
 - Plane
2. Holding a bag of transportation cards, have each child pick a transportation card out of a bag and have the children make the sound that the form of transportation on the card makes.

Intermediates:

1. Discuss the sounds various forms of transportation make. As a group have the children answer what sound or sounds do the following forms of transportation make:
 - Train
 - Truck
 - Motorcycle
 - Car
 - Boat
 - Plane

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2. Tell children to think of something they would like to ride in and to think of what sound it makes. On a signal, everyone begins to make the sound they have chosen. Children move around the room, trying to find the same kind of transport by the same sound, until all the trains are together, all the ships, helicopters, and so on.
3. Pick transportation cards out of a bag and have the children make the sound that the form of transportation on the card makes.

Advanced

1. Discuss the sounds various forms of transportation make. As a group have the children answer what sound or sounds do the following forms of transportation make:
 - Train
 - Motorcycle
 - Truck
 - Car
 - Boat
 - Plane/ helicopter
2. Tell children to think of something they would like to ride in and to think of what sound it makes. On a signal, tell the children to begin to make the sound they have chosen. Children move around the room, and try to find the same kind of transport by the same sound, until all the trains are together, all the ships, helicopters, and so on.
3. Pick transportation cards out of a bag and have the children make the sound that the form of transportation on the card makes.



Musical Boats

Objective:

- To have fun and to learn to pay attention.
- To work together in groups and cooperate with one another.

Materials needed:

- String or wool, scissors
- Musical instrument, e.g. shaker or tambourine

Preparation:

1. Cut about 8 pieces of string about 2 meters/feet in length. Knot the ends of each piece of string together to make circles or 'boats'.

Instructions:

Beginners:

1. Place the circles ('boats') on the floor if doing the activity indoors or on the ground if playing outside. Tell the children to 'swim' in the sea, while you play music. "When the music stops, the children jump into a 'boat'."
2. Each time the music stops, the teacher removes a 'boat' so that more and more children have to crowd into each circle.

Intermediate/Advanced:

1. Place the circles ('boats') on the floor if doing the activity indoors or on the ground if playing outside. Tell the children to 'swim' in the sea, while you play music. "When the music stops, the children jump into a 'boat'."
2. Each time the music stops, the teacher removes a 'boat' so that more and more children have to crowd into each circle.
3. Have the children take turns playing the music and add on different 'kinds of swimming' (i.e. circle arms forward, one arm, one leg etc) If the children don't know about swimming, role play the motions. If possible, get a picture of a person swimming.

B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Wood and Box Construction

Objective:

- To encourage children to discover more about how things move.
- To develop problem solving skills.

Materials needed:

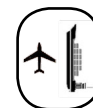
- Off-cuts of wood of different shapes and sizes
- Plastic containers (e.g. margarine), bottles
- Cardboard cut into circles for wheels
- Scissors, strong glue
- Cardboard boxes of different sizes
- Thick cardboard (from boxes)
- String, sticks, pieces of wire

Preparation:

1. Sand down the pieces of wood so that they are free of splinters. Remove any sharp objects such as nails from the wood. Sort the scrap materials into larger storage boxes. Place picture posters of the different kinds of transportation on the walls.

Instructions:

1. Let children freely design what they choose to make with the scrap materials provided. String can be tied around constructions while glue is drying.
2. Help children to plan what they are making and to solve their own problems by asking questions, such as:
 - *What could you use to hook the trucks / coaches to each other to make your train?*
 - *What makes the airplane go?*
 - *How does it land on the ground?*
3. Children can paint their constructions when dry



Wet Paper Painting

Objectives:

- To explore what happens when paper absorbs water and when paint is applied to it.
- To experiment with making different kinds of paintings.

Materials needed:

- Different kinds of paper and scrap cardboard
- Sponges, water, mixed paint, brushes
- Dry powder paint, containers with holes in for sprinkling, e.g. spice jars, pepper pots.

Instructions:

Beginners:

1. Give each child a tray, piece of board or thick cardboard to work on (or work on a large surface like a porch where the paintings can be left to dry). Put the paper on the board before wetting it. This is because it is very difficult to move wet paper and put it somewhere to dry.
2. Demonstrate how to dampen the paper with a wet sponge (wipe the paper lightly). Encourage the children to talk about what happens to the water and how the paper feels.
3. Ask a child to paint something with a brush and talk about what happens. Another child can sprinkle some dry paint on the damp paper.

Intermediate/Advanced:

1. Give each child a tray, piece of board or thick cardboard to work on (or work on a large surface like a porch where the paintings can be left to dry). Put the paper on the board before wetting it. This is because it is very difficult to move wet paper and put it somewhere to dry.
2. Demonstrate how to dampen the paper with a wet sponge (wipe the paper lightly). Encourage the children to talk about what happens to the water and how the paper feels.
3. Ask a child to paint something with a brush and talk about what happens. Another child can sprinkle some dry paint on the damp paper.
4. Encourage the children to experiment with wetting different kinds of paper and then making designs on it with wet paint and/or dry paint. Help them talk about what happens by asking questions.



Water Transportation Number Game

Objective:

- To match number sets, concentrate and follow rules
- To encourage children to observe details, to identify similarities and differences, and understand part-whole relationships.

Materials needed:

- 4 pieces of thick cardboard (from cartons)
- 4 copies of the 9 sets of number dots
- Plastic contact or varnish (if available)
- Dice (or dots 1-6 on small pieces of card that children can draw out of a bag)
- Storage box divided into 4 sections
- 4 drawings (ship, yacht, rowing boat, submarine)
- Crayons, scissors and paste

Preparation:

1. Color in the drawings of the boats.
2. Stick each picture onto a piece of cardboard. One the back of each picture stick a sheet of the number dots.
3. Cut each picture into 9 cards along the lines on the back.
4. If possible cover the cards with clean contact or paint with clear varnish to strengthen and protect it.

Instructions:

1. Introduce the game to the children. Explain the rules of the game and see that they are followed.
2. 2 to 4 children can play at a time. Each child selects a picture and places the cards in front of him/her with the number sides up.
3. The first child throws the dice (or takes a small card out of a bag) and selects a card with the corresponding number of dots. He turns the card over so that a piece of picture shows.
4. The next child throws the dice and selects from her cards in the same way.
5. If a six is thrown the child can choose any card.
6. When the children have learned how to play, they can be left to finish the game on their own.
7. As the cards are turned over to show the picture pieces, the children put their pieces together like a puzzle. The first child to finish the whole picture is the winner.



Making Propellers

Objective:

- To encourage creativity in making patterns.
- To develop eye-hand coordination

Materials needed:

- Square pieces of paper (about 15x15 cm/inches)
- Paints and brushes
- Scissors, drawing pins or small nails
- Hammer, sticks

Instructions:

1. Tell children they are going to make propellers. Each child paints his/her own design on a square piece of paper.
2. Fold the paper diagonally and open the paper again. Show the children the lines made by folds.
3. Children cut along each line leaving a space in the middle.
4. Pull one corner (numbered) of each piece into the centre.
5. When the four corners are all in place, fasten the propeller to a stick with a hammer and nail (or drawing pin).

N.B. teachers need to supervise the activity carefully and show children how to use the hammer and nail so that they do not hurt themselves.

*When the propellers are complete, let the children run outside with them pretending they are airplanes.



Paper Bag Kites

Objective:

- To encourage children to use their creative skills and imagination in painting their kites.
- To help children learn that air currents can be used to move things.

Materials needed:

- Large paper bags
- Paint and brushes
- Paste, stapler or sticky tape, scissors
- Wool or string, colored paper

Preparation:

1. Fold in the corners of the closed end of the bag. Glue, tape or staple it in place.
2. Punch or make a hole in the centre of the closed end. Thread a string through and knot it tightly. Each kite should have about 3 meters/feet of string.
3. Cut the paper into long, narrow strips.

Instructions:

1. Children paint designs on their kites.
2. They then stick the strips of paper onto the kite as streamers.

* During outside playtime, show them how to use the kite - loop the free end of the string over the hand and run against the wind to fly the kite.



Floating and Sinking

Objective:

- To learn more about things that float and sink.
- To practice making and testing predictions.

Materials needed:

- Large plastic basin for water
- Objects made of metal, wood and plastic in different
- Containers such as detergent bottles, margarine tubs
- Two Boxes for objects
- Water play aprons (improvised plastic shopping bags)
- Shapes and sizes
- Sponges, pieces of material, corks, plastic bottle tops

Instructions:

Beginners:

1. First, let children experiment freely to find out whether the objects sink or float when placed in water.
2. Ask a child to choose an object and tell you whether he thinks it will float or sink. Ask them to feel the texture (Is it hard or soft, spongy?) and weight (light or heavy).
 - *Do you think the cork will float or sink? Why?*
 - *How does it feel? What is it made of?*
 - *Did more things float or more sink?*
3. After the predictions, have the child put the object in the water to see if the prediction is correct. He then places it in the 'sink' or 'float' box. Children take turns to predict and then find out with each object. As they continue to experiment they will start to predict more accurately.
4. When all the objects have been used, look at the things that float and those that sink. Talk about what the reasons for this could be. Encourage children to look at similarities between different things. For example, a child may observe that all plastic things float.

Intermediate/Advanced:

Extension: The next day put out some more objects (children can bring them). Suggest that first they group all the objects that sink in one box and the objects that float in another box. Then they test in the water to see if they are right.





Rafts and Boats

Objective:

- To extend children's understanding of how things float and sink using boats and rafts (i.e. a collection of logs or pieces of wood fastened together for floating on water. It is flat can carry people, animals, materials, etc. across water. It doesn't sink.).

Materials needed:

- Large plastic container with water
- Sardine and other tins, large seed pods, plastic lids
- Plastic bottles; variety of small objects like small stones
- String, sharp object, balance scale
- Open containers such as margarine tubs, plastic cups
- Clay or play dough, paper, flat pieces of wood, sticks
- Sticks, buttons, shells

Instructions:

1. Encourage children to discover for themselves how to make open containers sink and how to float things like stones on water, e.g. *What would happen if you put some stones into the cup? How could you make it sink to the bottom?*
2. They can load different small objects into the various open containers to see how much weight something can hold before it sinks. *Which one holds the most weight?* Use a balance scale.
3. They can see what happens when they fill containers with water.
4. They can make holes (leaks) in plastic things. *Will a flat plastic coffee tin lid sink, even with a hole in it?*
5. They can make simple boats from the clay and play-dough and experiment with them in the water - see what happens. They could also make paper boats.
6. They can make rafts out of pieces of wood or by tying sticks together with string to float things on.
7. Ask them questions to help them discover that the flatter the shape the longer it will take to sink, and that things that soak up water or leak will sink



Sailing Boats

Objective:

- To help children understand how wind is used to make things move.

Materials needed:

- Empty plastic bottles
- Paper, ruler, pencil, scissors, knife, sticky tape
- Straws or light sticks
- Large plastic container for water, plastic aprons

Preparation:

1. Make a variety of boats in the following way.
2. Cut the bottle in half along its length.
3. Lay the half bottle down on its side and press the sticky tape to the middle of the bottom of the boat.
4. Fold the piece of paper in half to make a triangle. Put the straw or stick inside the triangle next to the folded crease, making sure that about 4 cm of the straw sticks out the paper. Use sticky tape to fix the stick in position.
5. Stand the 'sail' up in the boat by pushing the straw into the sticky tape.

**** Note:** Older children can help with making the boats, but will require supervision and help, e.g. with cutting the bottles.**

Instructions:

1. Let the children float the boats in the water. Talk about the different parts of the boat and ask how the boat could move without being touched. Ask what they think the sail could be used for. Let the children blow the sails.
2. Encourage them to experiment with blowing in different directions.
3. A few children could have a boat race. Ask what would happen if they were sailing and the wind stopped.

C. IDEAS FOR OUTDOOR ACTIVITIES



Ship or Boat

Objective:

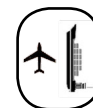
- To encourage children to use their imaginations.
- To develop social skills by encouraging children to share and take turns.

Materials needed:

- Large blocks or cardboard boxes, planks
- Sticks for the oars, cushions and mats
- Dress-up clothes, captain's cap
- Sheet, long stick (mast), improvised steering wheel
- Improvised anchor, fishing rods from sticks and string
- Flags made from cloth and sticks

Instructions:

1. Outline a boat with the blocks on the ground. Create a ramp for getting onto the boat with a plank and box. Make a sail with the sheet and a long stick, and fix it into the ground inside the boat. Place the steering wheel in the front of the boat.
2. Children can fish with the fishing rods, sail or row the boat as well as steer it, let down and pull up the anchor. They can take turns being the captain who gives the commands. Flags can be used to send messages to other Z boats or ships.



Balloon Power

Objective: To encourage children to use their imaginations.

Materials needed:

- Long balloons
- Straws or thin tubes
- String, scissors, sticky tape

Instructions:

1. Tie one end of a long piece of string to the back of a chair.
2. Thread the other end through a straw or thin tube.
3. You will initially need to explain and help children to get started. Two children will need to do the activity.
4. One child blows up the balloon and holds the end tight to stop the air escaping. She then holds the end of the string and pulls it straight with her other hand.
5. Another child uses the sticky tape to fasten the balloon to the straw at the front (closed end of balloon towards the chair) and the back.
6. The child holding the balloon pulls the string tightly. When everything is ready, she lets the balloon go. The balloon rocket shoots along the string for the whole length - the escaping air pushes the balloon forward.
7. Encourage children to talk about what they are doing and what happens. Ask and answer questions that the children may have.
8. Explain to children that air is also used in a similar way in some engines to make things move.



Windsock (i.e., a cone-shaped cloth open at both ends and mounted high up to show the direction of the wind)

Objective: To help children learn more about the wind, and how it is used in making things move.

Materials needed:

- Piece of cloth material (white)
- Piece of wire (e.g. from a coat hanger), pliers
- Pictures of airplanes and sailing boats
- Needle and cotton, scissors
- Long stick, plastic shopping bags

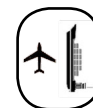
Preparation:

1. Make a circle from the wire. Don't cut the ends off.
2. Sew two sides of a piece of material together to make a tube that will fit around the circle of wire.
3. Fix one end of the material onto the circle of wire, and fasten the end pieces of the wire around the stick.

Instructions:

1. Do this activity on a day when the wind is blowing. Select a place outside where you can place the stick in the ground. Before you put it up, take the children outside.
2. Ask them if they can see the wind. Can they feel it? Encourage children to talk about how it feels on our clothes, body and hair. Tell children to turn their backs to the wind, turn their fronts to the wind. Give them plastic shopping bags to catch the wind and feel how it pulls. Several children could also hold up a large piece of sheet.
3. Ask them the direction they think it is coming from – how do they know this? Put up the windsock. Talk about how airplane pilots and sailors need to know the way the wind is blowing and how strong it is. What does it mean if the sock is not waving? Tell them that the windsock will show them the direction of the wind even when they are sitting inside.

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- *How does the wind feel on your body/hair/clothes?*
 - *Where is the wind coming from?*
 - *How do you know? Can you see the wind?*
 - *If you were sitting inside, how would you know where the wind was blowing from?*
 - *How would you know when there was no wind?*
 - *What would happen to sailing boats if the wind stopped blowing?*
 - *Why does the airplane pilot need to know which way the wind is blowing?*
4. The children can also try flying their paper airplanes in the wind and observe what happens.
 5. Begin reviewing and comparing the different forms of transport. Ask the children to explain how the wind moves sailing boats. Before ships had engines, they used to sail across the sea with many sails (have you got a picture of an old sailing boat?).
 6. Ask them why they think airplane pilots need to know which way the wind is blowing - because it helps airplanes to take off from the ground (in the same direction as the wind) and when landing (against the wind). The wind helps gliders move (although they are towed up into the air, like the children need to throw their paper airplanes into the air). What about kites?
 7. Can they think of anything else that the wind or air is used for? They may be familiar with windmills which are used to pump water. We put air in car tires. Why? Life jackets are blown up with air to help people float in water. Submarines use air to push water out of tanks to come to the surface.

Extension: For the next few days during group time, ask the children to look at the windsock and tell you about the wind that day.



III: MARKETS AND PLAYGROUNDS

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

The market is a good place to spend time with young children. There is so much to see and learn about. Take small groups of children, if possible, since the market is often crowded and could be confusing and scary for young children. Before going on a walk to a market, discuss during Morning Meeting a particular aspect of the market you wish to focus on. For example, the topic for the week might be vegetables, fruits, and meats. Discuss what they might see: cassava, mangos, chickens. When you are at the market, play an “I spy” game to see who can find a particular item. Another trip to the market might focus on clothing. Have the children guess what they might see, and play a similar game when they get there. Repetition is important for young children. Building vocabulary and memory can be strengthened through thinking about the market, actually going and seeing items, and then repeating what they saw on their return or at the next day’s Morning Meeting.

Outdoor play is very important for young children. It is not just “play” for them. All the domains of development are addressed through play out-of-doors: gross and fine motor skills, language development, social and emotional skills (sharing, taking turns, self-control, problem-solving, expressing feelings), approaches to learning (perseverance, motivation to learn, creative expression). In addition, many indoor activities can be done outdoors, such as reading a book, using sand and water, painting, using tools to “fix” things. Outdoor play should be thought of as any other important part of the day, as an important time for learning. Teachers should be available to facilitate learning, help solve disputes and conflict, foster team spirit, lending supportive words of encouragement, etc.



WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – February, Week 1 and 2

III: Markets and Playgrounds

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • KWL Chart	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • What Can We See at the Market?	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • What Can We See at the Market?	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • People Who Work at the Market	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • KWL Chart
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups Week 1	Classify Market Goods	Community Goods	Classify Market Goods	Community Goods	No Small Groups
	Small Groups Week 2	Classify Market Goods	Community Goods	Classify Market Goods	Community Goods	No Small Groups
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Visit Market	Market Stories	Visit Market	Market Stories	Free Play
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.00 – 12.45	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	• Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic. • Discovery Box: exploring sounds, tastes, smells, things found in nature and manufactured • Movement game "Touch blue..." • Asking questions about what did children find during Sense Walk				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	• Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				
Activities with Parents throughout the day		• Parents can volunteer in Small Group activities • Parents can join in songs, games, books, storytelling • Parents can go with class on a Community Walk				



A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



KWL Chart

Objectives:

- To introduce topic based on the children's existing knowledge.
- To develop children's planning skills.

Materials needed:

- Pictures or photos of local markets
- Large sheets of paper

Preparation:

1. Prepare the KWL Chart by drawing three columns on a large sheet of paper.
2. Label the tops of each column label with the following: **K** – what do we Know, **W** – what do we Want to know, and **L** – what we Learned.

Instructions:

1. Ask children whether they visited the markets with their parents or other family members. Let them share their stories.
2. Ask children what they know already about the markets based on their experience. Write down their answers on the sheet of paper within the column "K".
3. Ask children what they want to know more about the markets and write down their responses within the second "W" column. Don't forget to write children's names under their responses.
4. You can also ask children how you are going to find out what interests them – it is very important for developing their planning skills and sharing "the power" of source of knowledge.
5. Come back to the KWL Chart every morning to review children's progress and interest to the topic.



What Can We See at the Market?

Objective:

- To expand children's vocabulary by introducing new words related to the topic.
- To develop children's planning skills

Instructions:

1. Tell children that today they will visit a market. Ask them what they think they can see there – try to ask questions according to the different categories: people and products.
2. You can also play “Guess What Am I” – e.g. “I have the yellow color and my taste is sweet” – what am I? (banana), etc.



People Who Work at the Market?

Objective: Children will learn the importance of people who sell things that we need to live.

Background/Prep:

Visits to the places where people work always are the exciting events for children and parents can contribute to them as well. However, visits of the people, who work there is also very valuable experience. It could be that some of the parents who work at the market, so their visit could be very important both in a way of sharing their experience and also their child would feel proud.

1. Visits need to be carefully planned so that each visit fits in related activities.
2. Send invitations to the visitor or talk to him/her before to explain the purpose clearly and confirm the time of the visit.

Instructions:

1. Before the visitor arrives at the classroom, prepare the children for the visit, and encourage them to ask questions during the visit. After the visitor leaves, help the children talk about what they learned about how people work at the market.

B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Classifying Market's Goods

Objectives: To develop children's cognitive skills by classifying market's goods.

Preparation:

1. You can use pictures cut out from the old magazines or/and drawings made by the children during Market Stories activity (p.XX). Prepare the cards with the names of different categories of products children can see at the market: e.g. "Fruits", "Vegetables", "Meat", "Fish", etc. and place them at the Morning Meeting area.

Instructions:

1. Put in the Morning Meeting area the pictures of different kinds of products, which can be found at the market and/or drawings made by children.
2. Ask children individually pick up the pictures and place it according to the specific categories. Encourage other children to help to find the appropriate category if the child is not sure.



Community Shop

Objectives:

- To develop communication and social skills by playing together cooperatively.
- To encourage imaginative role play by dressing up and pretending to go to the community shop/grocery store.
- To create the awareness of shape, number and one-to-one correspondence.

Materials needed:

- Big cardboard boxes of different sizes, chairs, planks of wood and bricks (if available)
- Selection of empty tins, packets, milk bottles, cool drink
- Bottles, oil bottles, margarine containers, cereal and other food boxes, sweet, chip and chocolate papers
- Papier-mâché fruit and vegetables
- Crayons
- Small containers or boxes
- Small pieces of scrap paper or card
- Old shopping bags (plastic or paper)
- Improvised purses, handbags and cash till (e.g. a sorting tray with lid)

Preparation:

1. Set up a shop in the make-believe corner of the room.
2. Use the big cardboard boxes, chairs or planks and bricks to make shelves for the shop.
3. Display the tins, bottles, packets on the shelves in an attractive way to look like a shop, e.g. all the cool drink tins together, cereal boxes, milk bottles and so on.
4. Put the old shopping bags over a chair or box in the shop where children can easily reach them. Use chairs or boxes to create an entrance to the shop.
5. Make 'money' with the small pieces of scrap paper. It is not necessary for the money to look like real money. You can also photocopy Liberian dollars and cut them out.

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6. Make lots of small circles, triangles, squares and rectangles. Color them in using different colors and use them as 'money'.
7. Stick different shapes or combinations of shapes onto the different items in the shop e.g. 2 red triangles and one blue circle onto some of the tins; 3 squares onto fruit; 1 green circle and 2 red squares onto the bottle and so on.
8. Make sure you have enough of these differently colored shapes for all the items in the shop and extras. Sort the extra shapes according to shape and color, and put these into small boxes. Place these boxes outside the shop near the entrance.
9. Arrange the usual make-believe dressing-up clothes, hats, bags and purses in such a way that children want to dress up.

Instructions:

1. Talk to the children about how the shop works. Children can take it in turns to be the shopkeeper. When children come to the shop they take some 'money' from the table outside to buy food in the shop.
2. The teacher can go shopping with the children initially to show them how to use their money. They have to match the 'money' shapes with the 'price' shapes stuck onto the different items in the shop. The shopkeeper has to check that the correct 'money' is given. If too many are given, he can give 'change'.
3. When children are familiar with the procedure teacher can leave them to play.

Beginner

1. After the visit to the market ask children to draw the pictures of what they liked the most there – children can work individually or in pairs or trios.
2. Encourage children to use pictures cut out from the old magazines or other any additional materials to make collage.

Intermediate/Advanced

3. For more advanced you can ask them to write/dictate stories about what they liked the most at the market to share them later with their parents.



Food Match Up

Objectives: Children will understand where food comes from.

Materials needed:

- Animal and food cards and pictures
- Scissors
- Crayons or markers
- Heavy paper, cardboard or old playing cards
- Glue or tape
- Clear contact paper (optional)

Preparation:

1. Color and cut out the food and animal cards. Pictures from magazines or other sources can be used as well.
2. Glue the food and animal cards to cardboard, heavy paper or old playing cards.
3. Cover with clear contact paper to increase durability.

Instructions:

1. Discuss the different foods that come from animals (cow, chicken, pig or other animals that are a common food source in the community).
2. Ask the children these questions:
 - *What foods can we get from cows? (milk, cheese, beef, steak, liver)*
 - *What foods can we get from chickens? (eggs, drumsticks, chicken breast meat, liver)*
 - *What foods can we get from pigs? (ham, sausage)*
3. Show the children the animal and food cards. Have them match the animals with the foods they provide.
4. Children can play a matching game with the animal and food cards individually or in pairs. Discuss why each food is good for growth and development of bones, muscles, and teeth.

NOTE: It is important for children to understand where food comes from. Children in rural areas are usually more familiar with this process than children who live in cities.



Visit the Market

Objectives:

- To observe different things that can be bought a market.
- To increase their memory.
- To increase their vocabulary.
- To learn how to walk together peacefully.

Materials Needed: None

Instructions:

1. Walk to a local market. Tell the children that they should remember as many different items as possible to write about when they return to the center.
2. Ask the children to look at all the things you can buy at a market.
3. Older children can observe the prices of items, or ask the shopkeeper the prices of items.



Visit the Market

Objectives: To develop children's creativity through drawing pictures and making up stories after visiting the market.

Materials Needed:

- Paper
- Crayons
- Glue
- Pictures from the old magazines/drawings

Instructions:

1. Ask children to draw and/or write about their trip to the market.
2. Encourage them talk about their drawings and record what they say next to the drawings.



IV: COMMUNITY HELPERS

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

This topic about the people who work in community services focuses on the different kinds of work that people do to help their community, especially teachers, religious leaders, health workers, postal workers and police officers.

The resource material for “Community Helpers” is suitable mainly for older children. It can also be used as extension of the topic “My Home”, which includes the local community. These topics could also be linked with the topic “My Family”. Teachers can use the resource material for topics “My Family” and “My Home” for planning most of their activities, while the older children review the family and home and do the more advanced activities relating to the community selected from all three topics.

Why is it important to help children learn more about people and the jobs they do? By the age of four, children are beginning to imagine what they might become when they grow up. It is important for the development of a sense of identity to have some idea of the many different work roles available. Children can learn the names of various occupations and understand a simple explanation of what each person does. The learning activities will increase children’s knowledge of their social environment, and children should be encouraged to think for themselves and contribute from their own experiences as much as they can.



WEEKLY PLANNING OVERVIEW – February, Week 3 and 4

IV: Community Helpers

Time	Type of Activity	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9.00 – 9.15	Morning Meeting	• Welcome children • Greetings • Prepare children for special activities that will happen later in the day or during the week • Introducing Community Helpers	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Community Health Helpers	• Welcome children • Greetings • The Post Office	• Welcome children • Greetings • Classroom Rules • Visits from Community Helpers	• Welcome children • Greetings • Discussion of what children have learned during the week
9.15 – 11.00	Work Time – Learning Centers: Teacher organizes materials for children to work in centers of the child's choice including: Art Center, Block Center, Drama Center, Literacy Center, Manipulative Center while one or two Small Groups are working on teacher-initiated activities.					
	Small Groups Week 1	Postcards	Post Sorting Game	Papier-mâché Building	Building a Community	Building a Community
	Small Groups Week 2	Papier-mâché Building	Postcards	Post Sorting Game		No Small Groups
11.00 – 11.15	Clean-Up					
11.15 – 12.00	Outdoor Time	Free Play	Free Play	Delivering Post Games	Delivering Post Games	Free Play
12.00 – 12.45	Wash-Up, Lunch					
12.00 – 12.45	Rest & Quiet Time	Children who can't sleep may "read" books.				
14.15 – 14.30	Group Story Time	• Social games, story reading, finger plays, singing, dramatization of the books, reading the children's books related to the topic. • Discovery Box: exploring sounds, tastes, smells, things found in nature and manufactured • Movement game "Touch blue..." • Asking questions about what did children find during Sense Walk				
14.30 – 15.00	Closing Meeting	• Review of the day, sharing impressions of the day, discussion of the activities children have been involved in – which new things they learned and planning the next day.				
Activities with Parents throughout the day		• Parents can assist in visiting the classroom and telling about their job/role • Parents can assist children in making their postcards • Parents can assist as volunteers in a field trip				



A. IDEAS FOR THE MORNING MEETING



Introducing Community Helpers

Objectives: Children will learn about the community workers/helpers and where they work..

Materials needed:

- Papier-mâché community buildings, children's house constructions, blocks, etc.
- Community helper posters
- Cardboard (e.g. from soap powder boxes)
- Scissors, crayons, paste

Preparation:

1. Cut out the figures of community helpers who work in the local community. Color in the drawings and paste them onto cardboard.
2. Make stand-up figures by cutting a strip of cardboard and pasting it to the back of each figure.
3. Set out a village/township scene with roads/streets, improvised houses and papier-mâché community buildings on the floor or a table where all the children can see it. Talk about the different buildings.

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Instructions:

Beginner	Intermediate	Advanced
1. Arrange the stand-up figures of community helpers in front of you. 2. One by one, ask the children if they know who these people are and place them in front of where they work on the village/township scene. Introduce names of the community helpers if necessary. Talk about what they are wearing and why some wear uniforms. – <i>How is he/she dressed?</i> – <i>How does she help us?</i> – <i>What do you like about the doctor?</i> – <i>What don't you like about the police officer?</i> – <i>What do you think would happen if there was no post office?</i> – <i>Where does the nurse work? What do you think it is called? What happens in the clinic?</i>	1. Arrange the stand-up figures of community helpers in front of you. Ask the children if they know who these people are. Introduce names of the community helpers if necessary. Talk about what they are wearing and why some wear uniforms. – <i>How is he/she dressed?</i> – <i>How does she help us?</i> – <i>What do you like about the doctor?</i> – <i>What don't you like about the police officer?</i> – <i>What do you think would happen if there was no post office?</i> – <i>Where does the nurse work? What do you think it is called? What happens in the clinic?</i> 2. Ask for a volunteer to put one of the figures next to the building she thinks that person works in. Discuss what children think happens in this building and what the community helper does. Use the relevant poster to show some of the things related to the work. 3. Continue in this way until all the figures have been set out. Talk about how some of these community helpers also travel to visit us if we live far from their place of work, e.g. nurses and mobile clinics.	1. Arrange the stand-up figures of community helpers in front of you. Ask the children if they know who these people are. Introduce names of the community helpers if necessary. Talk about what they are wearing and why some wear uniforms. – <i>How is he/she dressed?</i> – <i>How does she help us?</i> – <i>What do you like about the doctor?</i> – <i>What don't you like about the police officer?</i> – <i>What do you think would happen if there was no post office?</i> – <i>Where does the nurse work? What do you think it is called? What happens in the clinic?</i> 2. Ask for a volunteer to put one of the figures next to the building she thinks that person works in. Discuss what children think happens in this building and what the community helper does. Use the relevant poster to show some of the things related to the work. 3. Continue in this way until all the figures have been set out. Talk about how some of these community helpers also travel to visit us if we live far from their place of work, e.g. nurses and mobile clinics.



Visits from Community Helpers

Objective: Children will learn about what doctors and police do so that they are not afraid

Background Information:

- Visits to the places where people work always are the exciting events for children and parents can contribute to them as well. However, visits of the people, who work there is also very valuable experience. Children are often afraid of doctors, nurses and dentists.
- Invite one of these people to bring some of the instruments that they use in their work and to explain what they are used for. (Care needs to be taken that children are not made to feel more afraid!) Encourage children to ask questions and to handle some of the instruments.
- Invite a police officer to come in uniform and to talk about the work that the police do – how they help people who are in trouble and keep us safe from people who want to hurt us.

Preparation:

Make a special puppet. The following idea is easy to make and easy for the children to handle. Make a bed for the puppet from a shoe box or similar sized box.

1. Visits need to be carefully planned so that each visit fits in with related activities.
2. Send invitations to these visitors well in advance so that visitors have time to prepare.
3. Explain the purpose clearly and confirm the time of the visit.
4. If visitors wear uniform or special clothes to work, ask them to come in their uniforms.
5. Prepare the children for the visit beforehand, and encourage them to ask questions during the visit.

Instructions:

1. Welcome the visitor and have them introduce their job.
2. Encourage the children to ask the visitor questions.
3. After the visitor leaves, help the children talk about what they learned about what the community helper does.
 - *How does he/she help us?*
 - *Why does she wear those clothes?*
 - *How does it work? (e.g. stethoscope)*
 - *How can it make us better?*
 - *Where does he work?*
 - *Who looks after her family when she goes to work?*



Community Health Helpers

Objectives: Children will learn the roles of the health helpers in their community.

Preparation:

1. Talk to community members, parents, organizations and other resources to find people who would be willing to come and visit or have the children visit them. Firefighters, police officers, nurses (you may have one at the school), doctors, eye doctors, counselors, animal catchers, sanitation or trash collectors, street sweepers and dentists- any member of the community who works in the community.
2. Talk to the health professionals about what to bring with them when they visit the classroom or what the children would like to see when they visit them. Explain that children are very concrete learners and need to manipulate materials. Ask them if they have things that can stay in the classroom for children to use.
3. Inform parents of your community health topic and ask them for ideas and suggestions. Many of them may be community health providers and enjoy coming to school or having the class visit!

Instructions:

1. Before someone visits discuss the idea of community health helpers with the children. Bring in pictures or books and talk about what each profession does and how they contribute to the health of the community.
2. Brain-storm with the children what they might see on their visit or the job that the person does. Make up a story or list of ideas about how each person contributes to the community health.
3. When the visitor comes, invite them to talk a little about what they do. The children will ask questions and will want to explore any clothes or equipment they bring.
4. For example, a nurse or a doctor may bring a stethoscope, blood pressure cuff, tongue depressor or other items. All of the children will want to touch, feel and use these items. Ask the visitor to explain in simple terms what they do.
5. After the visit have the children make and send or deliver a thank you card to the visitor. Have them explain or draw what they liked most or what they learned.



B. IDEAS FOR THE SMALL GROUP ACTIVITIES



Postcards

Objectives: To encourage children's imagination and creativity and help children learn more about writing.

Materials needed:

- Pieces of thick paper or thin cardboard about 12 by 15 cms in size
- Small stamp size pieces of paper
- Wax crayons or paint and brushes, paste old postcards

Instructions:

1. Show the children the postcards. Suggest to them that they make their own postcards which they can send in the post (either for make-believe play or, if possible, the real post which will require stamps).
2. Encourage children to draw any pictures they like.
3. When each child completes the postcard drawing, write the name and address of the person (e.g. a family member) he wishes to "send" it to on the back. Explain what are you doing as you write.
4. The older children may also want you to write a short message on the card to the person. If the child can write his name, let him put it at the bottom of the message.
5. If stamps are not available, ask each child to draw a stamp on a small piece of paper for his postcard and put it in the box.
6. Keep the postcards and "stamps" together. Tell the children that they will either post their cards in a real post box (if an outing can be arranged) or during a group time.



Building a Community Store

Objectives:

- To encourage children to think and talk about the buildings and helpers in their communities.
- To develop children's planning skills and cooperation

Materials needed:

- Large cardboard box, masking tape, paint, paste and scissors
- Variety of small boxes, inside tubes of toilet rolls
- Clay or papier-mâché, leaves, twigs, corks, pieces of cloth

Preparation:

1. Flatten the cardboard box, cut it into two halves and tape them together to make a large flat piece. Paint in a road, some green for grass and blue for a dam.
2. Set out the activity with the materials listed above in a special place where the children can work undisturbed

Instructions:

1. Have the children construct houses and buildings out of materials set out. Suggest to the children that they build their own village or town.
2. After they build a house/building, tell them to place their construction on the board.
3. Ask questions about the other buildings in the community.
4. Talk about the people who work in the buildings. Suggest that they make people with the clay or papier-mâché. Materials such as leaves and twigs can be used to make trees or plants.



Papier-mâché Buildings

Objectives: To encourage children to use their imaginations when building with blocks.

Materials needed:

- A variety of cardboard boxes
- Papier-mâché
- Paint and brushes

Preparation:

1. Cut out the boxes to make buildings such as the police station, mobile clinic, shops, school and church.
2. Strengthen the boxes with papier-mâché and paint.
3. Make people (community helpers) from clay or papier-mâché and paint or 'dress' them with bits of cloth, or use people made by the children.
4. Set out the papier-mâché buildings and people in the area with the blocks

Instructions:

1. Talk to the children about the different buildings and what they are used for.
2. Encourage children to play make-believe games using all the different materials you have added.



The Clinic or Day Hospital

Objectives: To encourage children's role play.

Materials Needed:

- Old white shirts, paper nurse's caps, apron
- Empty plastic bottles and pill containers (washed)
- Strips of cloth for bandages, cotton-wool, and crutches fasten 2 pieces of string to a small lid;
- Make a loop at each end of the string for a child to put round her ears and use the lid to listen to the chest (stethoscope)
- Old black handbag (for doctor's bag), play telephone
- Beds, improvised stretcher, old scale.

Instructions:

1. Set out the materials in a special area to look like a clinic or day hospital.
2. Encourage children to play doctors and nurses by playing with them for a short time.
3. Show them how to roll the bandages and use them.
4. Children can also sort pill containers by size and shape.



How to Make a Nurse's Cap

Objective: To learn about health care provider and to encourage role play.

Materials needed:

- Thin white cardboard or thick paper (about 21 x 30 cms)
- Stapler or sticky tape, hairclips

Instructions:

1. Draw a line across the length of the cardboard/paper 5 cms from the edge. Fold along the line.
2. Fold the cardboard as above and staple or tape it. Overlap the corner points about 2 cms when stapled or fastened with tape.
3. Fasten the cap to the child's hair with a hairclip



The Post Office

Objective: To encourage children's role play.

Materials Needed:

- Old dark shirt or jacket, cap, bag postbox (see below, table for counter, play money, used envelopes, used stamps (or improvised), two tins joined by string (telephone).

Instructions:

1. Set out the materials in a special area to look like a post office. Perhaps make a 'telephone booth' nearby.
2. Encourage children to play make-believe games relating to letter-writing, buying stamps, posting, sorting mail and using the telephone.



How to Make a Letter Box

Objectives: To increase fine motor skills and to learn the concept of a letter box.

Materials needed:

- 2 or 3 large cardboard boxes of the same size, masking tape, scissors, paste, paint and paintbrushes

Instructions:

1. Cut a slot for posting into the side of one of the boxes.
2. Seal the boxes with the masking tape. Then stick them together one on top of the other.
3. Paint with red paint (if available).



Letter Bag

Objective: Children will develop their arts and creativity skills by decorating the letter bags as well as their fine motor skills.

Materials needed:

- A large brown paper bag, scissors, stapler or needle and thread, masking tape, crayons

Instructions:

1. Cut 10 cms off the top of the paper bag. Cut this piece down the middle to make one long strip.
2. Fold this strip in half lengthwise (for strap).
3. Fold in about 3 cms along the rim of the paper bag.
4. Flatten the bag and staple or stitch the sides so that the bottom of the bag becomes a pocket.
5. Staple or stitch the long strip to each side to make a shoulder strap.
6. Cover the stapled/stitched sides with masking tape to strengthen the bag.
7. Decorate the bag with crayons.



Delivering Letter Games

- Objective:**
- To help children count (one-to-one correspondence)
 - To encourage children's cooperative play using rules

- Materials needed:**
- Selection of used letters and/or parcels, chalk or masking tape
 - Game board, place cards, dice (or numerals written on small cards) if available

- Preparation:**
1. Mark out on the floor or on flat ground a simple road map (similar to the game board) so that the roads are wide enough for a child to walk on.
 2. Divide the roads into 20 to 30 blocks and discuss with the children where to place 5 or 6 suitable model buildings along the roads.

- Instructions:**
1. The idea is that the children first learn to play the game by 'doing it' on the floor and then later they can use the game board.

- Floor Game:**
- The floor game can be played by two players or by two teams. Each player holds at least two 'letters' or 'parcels'. They begin by choosing a place on the road map to start.
 - The first player throws a large dice (or draws a small number card from a bag) and decides which way to move the same number of blocks as shown on the dice (card). The aim is to land next to a model building to deliver one of the letters (or parcels).
 - The players take turns to throw the dice. The game continues until all letters are delivered.

The game can be made more challenging by adding more 'letters' and/or 'parcels' to deliver, and by giving each 'letter' or 'parcel' a specific 'address' (identify the place each should be delivered to with a color code or drawing of the building). Each member of the team could be given a different 'letter' and they must decide together which letter could be delivered after each throw of the dice.



Letter Sorting Game

- Objective:**
- To develop children's cognitive skills (sorting)
 - To help children learn new words

Materials needed:

- 4 shoe boxes (or similar-sized boxes with lids)
- Poster drawings of doctor, police officer, postal worker, teacher and related things
- Scissors, paste, crayons
- 20 used envelopes

Preparation:

1. Color in and cut out the drawings of the 4 community helpers. Paste each picture on a box.
2. Cut a slit in the lid of each box, big enough for the envelopes to go through.
3. Color in and cut out the drawings (or look for pictures in magazines) that relate to each community worker (5 of each). Paste each drawing onto an envelope

Instructions:

1. Children sort the envelopes according to the community helper they belong with.
2. Help children by sitting with them and talking about the pictures. Introduce new words and ask questions about what the objects are used for. Then ask, Which community helper uses the ...? *So which box should you post the envelope in?*

ADVANCED Ask children what other things could be added to each box. Extend children's interest by encouraging them to cut out their own pictures to add to the collection.

C. IDEAS FOR OUTDOOR ACTIVITIES

1. Take a walk in the neighborhood and look for community helpers. If possible have the children talk to them, asking them what they do, how they like their job, what their training was for the job, etc.
2. Take a walk in the neighborhood with the intention of finding a particular community helper. Focus on who you will be looking for at Morning Meeting. Have the children search for the person on their walk. When they find the helper, have the children watch what he or she is doing. Go back and “draw” what they have seen. For older children, have them dictate a story about their walk. Put all of the children’s drawings together to make a book that can be put in the Literacy Learning Center for “reading.”